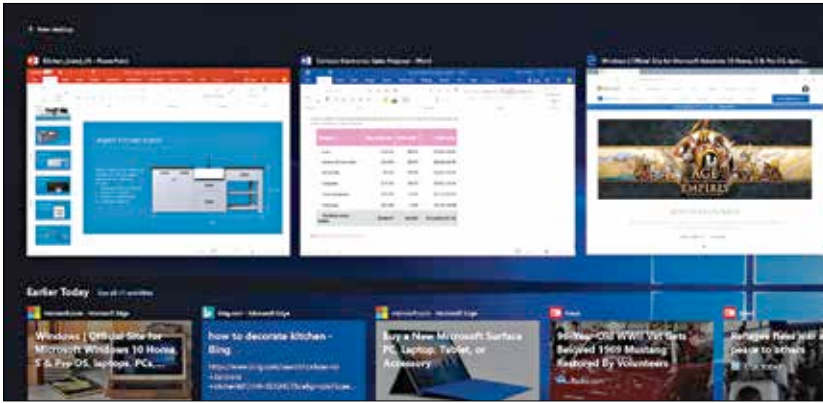




all the apps to the next desktop lower down the line.

OPTIMISE MEMORY USE

This is a tip that can be used to increase the performance of your machine without directly accessing and changing the hardware. A high speed memory card or USB drive can be used for this purpose, provided it has at least 500 MB free space. The more available, the better will be the performance boost. The external memory does not have to be completely empty, but this method works better if it is. Once the USB drive or memory card is inserted, go to Explorer and right click on the storage. Go to **Properties > ReadyBoost > Use This Device**. You can then select the amount of free space to use on the device, and Windows creates a file that is as large as your choice on the storage. This memory optimisation technique is particularly helpful on old, low-end, and mid-range laptops that struggle when you have too many tabs open in an internet browser.

MAKE CURSOR MORE VISIBLE

Particularly useful for the elderly, these options allow you to make the pointer larger and the cursor wider. Go to **Settings > Ease of Access > Cursor & Pointer** to see these options. Here you can adjust the pointer size till it is comfortably visible, and see a live preview of the text cursor which can increase the width up to three characters wide. The options here also allow you to change the colour of the mouse pointer, and set a behavior where it switches colour to always

stay in contrast with the background, instead of the default white pointer with a black border.

GOD MODE

If you are a power user, and frequently change the settings in the system, it can be a pain to navigate the settings window, finding the specific settings you need and changing them. A feature called 'God Mode' lets you view all the system settings in the Quick Access folder of Windows Explorer, giving you system wide access to settings. This allows you to quickly access system maintenance tasks, change the behavior of the connected hardware, and change the settings across the OS. Create a new folder on the desktop, and rename it to God-Mode . {ED7BA470-8E54-465E-825C-99712043E01C}, then double click it to access the settings in this format. Note that if you want to access the settings in the God Mode folder, it is necessary to go through this method. Also, the regular explorer remains as it is without any changes.

PROTECT YOUR FILES

From corruption of hard disk drives, to being locked by ransomware, there are all kinds of things that can happen to your files, and it is better to protect at least the critical ones. There are many approaches that you can use to do this. One option is to backup all files from critical folders to Microsoft OneDrive. To do this, right click on One Drive, go to **Settings > Account > Choose Folders > Choose Folders** and select the folders that you want to sync with OneDrive. If anything goes wrong with your machine, you can restore the files from the cloud. Do note that the sync does not work in some situations, such as when a laptop is put in battery saving mode. Another option is to go to Settings and search for **Ransomware Protection**, then select the folders to add to the **Protected Folders** list, by toggling the **Controlled Folder Access** option to on. Programs installed on the computer cannot access these protected folders, and hence cannot mess with the files saved there. If you have a network drive or a connected hard disk, you can use it to automatically backup your computer data and then later restore the files from there in case something goes wrong. To do this, go to **Settings**, search for **File History** and add a connected drive.

PAINT WITH 3D

Windows now has not one, but two default paint programs installed. Paint 3D is a really powerful software that can be used for a wide range of purposes, from creating custom

